



भारत सरकार

पत्र सूचना कार्यालय



Culture &amp; Tourism

## Yoga: India's Gift to the World

Celebrating a Journey of a Tradition that Transcends Borders

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### Key Takeaways

- **1. Growing Participation Each Year**

2018: 9.59 crore people took part

2024: 24.53 crore people joined globally

- **2. Record-Breaking Events**

2023: Guinness World Record at UN with 135 nationalities

2024: Multiple records including 25.93 lakh online pledges in UP

- **3. Global Campaigns**

2022: Yoga at iconic sites like Eiffel Tower, Dead Sea and Mount Everest base

2023: *Ocean Ring of Yoga*

- **4. IDY 2025 Highlights**

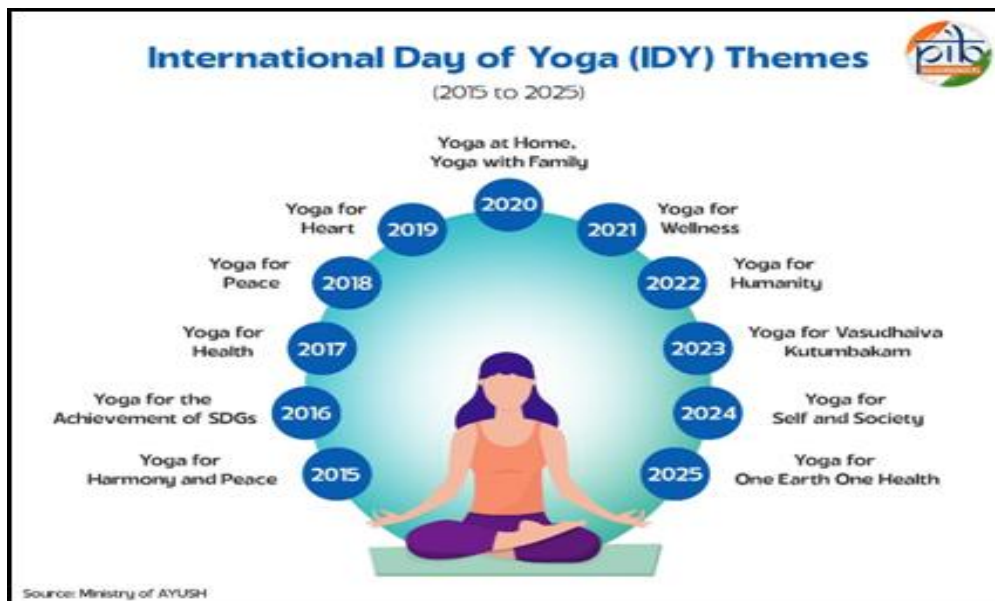
Theme: *Yoga for One Earth, One Health*

Over 1 lakh locations to host mass yoga; main event in Visakhapatnam

### Introduction



Yoga, rooted in India's ancient wisdom, has become a global symbol of health and harmony. Since 2015, India has led the world in celebrating International Day of Yoga with growing participation each year. From iconic global landmarks to rural villages, yoga has touched millions of lives. It promotes physical fitness, mental peace and a balanced lifestyle. The journey of yoga over the past 11 years reflects India's message of unity, wellness and inner strength.



On **27th September 2014**, Prime Minister Narendra Modi proposed at the UN to celebrate 21st June as International Yoga Day. On 11th December 2014, the United Nations officially declared 21st June as the International Day of Yoga, with support from 193 member states and 173 co-sponsors. Since then, Yoga Day is celebrated worldwide every year.

## 2015: Yoga for Harmony and Peace



The first International Yoga Day was held on **21st June 2015** at **Rajpath, New Delhi**, led by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**. Two **Guinness World Records** were made that day. One for the largest yoga class with **35,985 people**, and the other for the highest number of participating nationalities, which was 84.

#### **2016: Yoga for the Achievement of SDGs**



Over **30,000 people** joined Prime Minister Narendra Modi for the main event at Capital Complex, Chandigarh. He announced national and international awards for recognizing contributions to Yoga and called for a focus on Yoga for diabetes. Around **50 lakh people** in India joined month-long Yoga training programmes. Globally, 191 UN member countries celebrated Yoga Day **between June 18 and 26, 2016**.

#### ***International Day of Yoga at the UN Peacekeeping Missions***

#### **2017: Yoga for Health**





Prime Minister Narendra Modi led the mass yoga demonstration with around **51,000 participants** at Ramabai Ambedkar Ground in Lucknow. To mark the occasion, the Ministry of AYUSH held an International Conference on ‘Yoga for Wellness’ in New Delhi on 10 and 11 October 2017. The conference was inaugurated by Vice President M. Venkaiah Naidu and was attended by around 600 delegates, including 80 yoga experts from 44 countries.

*Troops of Indian Army celebrated International Day of Yoga at Nurla, Ladakh*

### **2018: Yoga for Peace**



At the Forest Research Institute in Dehradun the event saw the participation of around **50,000 people**. Another major event was held at Red Fort in Delhi by Brahmakumaris, with nearly 30,000 participants, including 2,000 women from the police force. In total, around 65,000 people joined the celebrations in

Delhi. Across the country, about **9.59 crore people** took part in the Yoga Day activities.

*The Ministry of Tourism celebrated the International Day of Yoga at the Qutub Minar Complex. Event saw a wide participation from public including more than 30 foreign hospitality guests.*

### **2019: Yoga for Heart**



The fifth International Day of Yoga was celebrated on 21st June 2019 with events held across all states and districts in India and in 150 countries worldwide. The main national event took place in Ranchi, Jharkhand, where Prime Minister Narendra Modi performed yoga with nearly **30,000 participants**. Yoga sessions were also held at iconic global locations like the Eiffel Tower, Opera House in Sydney, the Washington Monument and Mount Everest base camp. Over **13 crore people** took part in Yoga Day activities across the country in 2019.

### *5th International Yoga Day goes global at the UN*

### **2020: Yoga at Home, Yoga with Family & 2021: Yoga for Wellness**

In 2020 and 2021, International Yoga Day was celebrated mainly through virtual events due to the COVID-19 pandemic. The Common Yoga Protocol was promoted to ensure uniformity in practice across the world. Videos were made available on YouTube in 22 Indian languages, 6 UN languages, and 9 other foreign languages. In 2020, around **12.06 crore** people participated, and in 2021 the number rose to **15.68 crore**.

## 2022: Yoga for Humanity



Around **22.13 crore people** participated in India, and the global outreach **reached nearly 125 crore**. Yoga sessions were held at 75 heritage and iconic sites in India. In 2022, a 24-hour **Global Yoga Ring** was also organized as part of the “One Sun One Earth” initiative.

*Ministry of Civil Aviation celebrated International Yoga Day in 2022, by organizing a massive Yoga demonstration of more than 2,000 people at Gwalior Fort.*

## 2023: Yoga for Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam

2023 saw record-breaking participation with around **23.14 crore people** joining the celebrations. Prime Minister Narendra Modi led the event at the UN Headquarters, setting a Guinness World Record for participation by people from over 135 nationalities. Another record was set in Surat, where over one lakh people gathered for a single yoga session. Unique initiatives like the ‘**Ocean Ring of Yoga**’ and ‘**Yoga from Arctic to Antarctic**’ were introduced. The “**Har Aangan Yoga**” campaign reached rural areas through events in panchayats, schools, anganwadis and health centres.





*International Yoga Day celebrations at the **United Nations Headquarters in New York.***

### **2024: Yoga for Self and Society**

Prime Minister Narendra Modi led the main event at Sher-i-Kashmir International Conference Centre in Srinagar. Around **24.53 crore** people took part in the celebrations. The event set several new records and was added once again to the Guinness Book of World Records. It marked another major milestone in the journey of Yoga.



*CISF personnel of Taj Mahal, Agra & Officials of ASI practiced yoga at UNESCO World Heritage site, Agra Fort on International Yoga Day 2024.*

### **Guinness World Records:**

- **25.93 lakh people** took an online pledge as part of the Yoga Shapath Abhiyan in Uttar Pradesh
- **Five new records** set by Akshar Yoga Kendra, founder Yogi Himalayan Siddhaa Akshar
- **1,000 students**, including 600 differently-abled, performed yoga asanas together in Andhra Pradesh
- **Longest continuous yoga practice** (12 hours) by Dr. Radhakrishnan Sarvepalli Rajasthan Ayurveda University in Jodhpur, Rajasthan
- Many institutions came together in Jaipur, coordinated by Jaipur Municipal Corporation and Govt of Rajasthan and **practised yoga for more than 1500 minutes** and created a new world record.

## 2025: Yoga for One Earth One Health



The 11th International Day of Yoga will be celebrated on 21st June 2025. The main event, **Yoga Sangam**, will feature a **mass yoga demonstration** based on the Common Yoga Protocol at over one lakh locations across India from 6:30 AM to 7:45 AM. Prime Minister Narendra Modi will lead the national event in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh. This year, the Ministry has also announced 10 signature events to mark the occasion.

## Conclusion

In the past 11 years, International Day of Yoga has become a global event. India has led the world in sharing the practice of yoga. People across countries and cultures now include yoga in their daily lives. From villages to global landmarks, yoga promotes health, peace, and balance. It stands as a timeless embodiment of India's cultural wisdom and global leadership in wellness. The journey of yoga continues;



bringing nations together in the spirit of harmony, healing, and holistic well-being.

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Santosh Kumar/ Sheetal Angral/ Kamna Lakaria

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